

Kaden Grace

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Updated: June 2026

DOCTORAL STUDIES	University of Tennessee – Knoxville Ph.D., Economics M.A., Economics	2027 (expected) 2024
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DISSERTATION COMMITTEE AND REFERENCES:

Matt Harris (Chair)
Department of Economics
University of Tennessee – Knoxville
E-mail: mharris@utk.edu

Seth Neller
Department of Economics
University of Tennessee – Knoxville
E-mail: sneller@utk.edu

Christian Vossler
Department of Economics
University of Tennessee – Knoxville
E-mail: cvossler@utk.edu

Jason Lindo
School of Economics
Georgia Institute of Technology
E-mail: jlindo@gatech.edu

PRIOR EDUCATION	University of Mississippi B.S., Economics B.A., Mathematics Honors: <i>summa cum laude</i> , Phi Kappa Phi	May 2022 May 2022
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FIELDS OF INTEREST	Primary: Public Economics, Health Economics Secondary: Labor Economics, Behavioral and Experimental Economics
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WORKING PAPERS	“The Eyes of Texas are Upon OB/GYNs: Physician Migration and Crowd-sourced Enforcement of Abortion Regulations” (<i>JMP</i>) <i>with Martin Andersen</i>
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Abstract: This paper studies the labor market effects of civil liability enforcement using Texas Senate Bill 8 (SB-8, 2021) as a natural experiment. A civil liability enforcement mechanism in this context allows any citizen to sue anyone who “aids or abets” a prohibited abortion for minimum damages of \$10,000. This “bounty law” lowers the evidentiary burden and expands the pool of potentially liable individuals, which raises expected operating costs and could incentivize out-migration for a broad set of physicians compared to traditional criminal enforcement. We exploit variation across physician specialties, states, and time in a triple-difference design, comparing reproductive health physicians to all other physicians in Texas against similarly abortion-hostile states before and after SB-8’s signing. Using a Medicare administrative provider panel of approximately 1.4 million physicians (2007–2022) and Wagescape job posting data (2016–2022), we find that reproductive health physicians did not leave Texas at differential rates following SB-8. The null result is consistent with the high fixed cost of interstate relocation, estimated at \$150,000 to \$250,000. Neither posted salaries nor job posting volume for reproductive health providers changed differentially. Our findings are corroborated by synthetic difference-in-differences and synthetic control estimators and provide a contrast to prominent media narratives of a large OB/GYN

exodus from Texas. We contribute to a rapidly emerging literature by providing evidence that civil liability enforcement had no detectable effect on the Texas physician labor market above and beyond the broader abortion policy environment.

“Saving for a Rainy Day: Experimental Evidence on Prize-Linked Saving and Financial Shocks”

(Under Review)

Abstract: Liquidity constraints and inadequate precautionary savings create financial vulnerability for low-income households who face costly credit markets when unexpected expenses arise. This paper presents a laboratory experiment integrating a dynamic life-cycle savings model with prize-linked savings accounts (PLSAs, which offer lottery-style prizes in lieu of guaranteed interest) to investigate whether the behaviorally-motivated intervention can increase savings under financial uncertainty. I find that PLSAs crowd-out traditional savings accounts by 36.3 to 33.0 percent. Total savings do not increase. This portfolio reallocation imposes costs in the low prize treatment: participants earn 16.7 percent less than control, with the largest crowding-out effects concentrated among not risk averse individuals who exhibit 43.3 percent reductions in traditional savings. PLSAs function primarily as portfolio substitutes rather than savings-creation tools. Heterogeneity across risk preferences suggests that PLSAs should be marketed to unbanked households who are not risk averse.

WORKS IN
PROGRESS

“The Economic Impact of Unemployment Insurance Reform in Tennessee”
with Matt Harris, Larry Kessler, and Alex Norwood

PRESENTATIONS

ISEO Summer School (Iseo, Italy), ASHEcon Annual Conference, Veritas Forum, Society of Government Economists Annual Conference, UTK Applied Microeconomics Group Workshop, UTK Internal Brownbag Seminar (x2) 2026

Southern Economic Association Annual Meeting, ASHEcon Annual Conference, UTK Applied Microeconomics Group Workshop, UTK Internal Brownbag Seminar 2025

UTK Applied Microeconomics Group Workshop, UTK Internal Brownbag Seminar 2024

UTK Experiment and Theory Group Workshop, UTK Applied Microeconomics Group Workshop, UTK Graduate Student Research Seminar 2023

UTK Graduate Student Research Seminar 2022

TEACHING

University of Tennessee – Knoxville

Instructor of Record

ECON 311: Intermediate Microeconomics	Summer 2026
ECON 311: Intermediate Microeconomics	Spring 2026

Teaching Assistant

ECON 211: Principles of Microeconomics	Fall 2022 – Spring 2023
ECON 311: Intermediate Microeconomics	Spring 2023
ECON 581: Mathematical Methods in Economics	Fall 2023

FELLOWSHIPS & AWARDS	Best Second-Year Thesis, <i>UT Knoxville</i>	2024
	Best First-Year Graduate Student, <i>UT Knoxville</i>	2023
	Walter Melville Bonham PhD Fellowship	2024
	J. Fred & Wilma Holly PhD Fellowship	2024
	Joseph & Barbara O'Donnell PhD Fellowship	2023
	Haslam Excellence Doctoral Fellowship	2022–2024

RESEARCH
EXPERIENCE

University of Tennessee – Knoxville

<i>Research Assistant (Graduate)</i>	2023–Current
Developed and curated a novel dataset of every physician and hospital in the U.S.: approximately 4.3M records per month across 19 years	
<i>Experimental Lab Manager</i>	2023–Current
Led the design and execution of 27 experimental sessions with 1,100+ participants	

SKILLS	Stata, R, Python, Excel, $\text{\LaTeX}$; causal inference: A/B testing, randomized controlled trials (RCTs), differences-in-differences (DiD), instrumental variables (IV), regression discontinuity (RD); machine learning (ML), generalized method of moments (GMM), generalized least squares (GLS), discrete choice modeling
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AFFILIATIONS	Member: Society of Government Economists, Southern Economic Association, American Society of Health Economists	
	Student Representative, Campus Advisory Board	2025–2026
	Chairperson, Doctoral Student Association	2023–2024
	Organizer, Graduate Student Research Seminar	2023–2025

LANGUAGES	English (native), French (fluent)
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